COURSE DESCRIPTION FORM: SS-1014: Expository Writing

INSTITUTION FAST School of Computing, National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences, Islamabad Campus

PROGRAM TO BE EVALUATED BS-CS: **Spring 2024**

Course Description

Course Code	SS-1014
Course Title	Expository Writing
Credit Hours	2
Course Instructors	Sanaa Ilyas, Rafia Zafar, Sumaiyya Naveed
Grading Policy	Absolute Grading
Policy about missed assessment items in the course	Retake of missed assessment items (other than sessional/ final exam) will not be held. A student who misses an assessment item (other than sessional / final exam) is awarded zero marks in that assessment item i.e., late submission will not be accepted. For missed sessional/ final exam, exam retake/ pre-take application along with necessary evidence are required to be submitted to the department secretary. The examination assessment and retake committee decide the exam retake/ pre-take cases.
Course Plagiarism Policy	Plagiarism in project or sessional/ final exam will result in F grade in the course. Plagiarism in an assignment will result in zero marks in the whole assignments category.
Prerequisites by Course(s) or Topics	None
Assessment Instruments with Weights (homeworks, quizzes, sessional exams, final exam, assignments, etc.)	Assessment with the weight. **Assessment Type** — **Weight** Assignments (2) — 06 Quizzes (4-5) — 12 Sessional Exams (2) — 24 Project — 08 Final Exam — 50
Course Coordinator	Sanaa Ilyas
URL (if any)	
Course Catalog Description	This course prepares undergraduates to become successful writers and readers of English. This integrated reading and writing skills course primarily focuses on practicing, developing and refining students' reading and writing skills for academic purposes. The course aims to develop academic reading skills with particular

<table>
<tr><td></td><td>emphasis on vocabulary development, critical reading, dictionary skills and analytical comprehension. Furthermore, the course prepares students achieve proficiency in assessing the writing situations and exploring new ideas. This course approaches the study of writing with a focus on audience, authorial voice, and style. It emphasizes on the writing process and the context governing the process.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Textbook</td><td>Course Pack</td></tr>
<tr><td>Reference Material</td><td>1. Successful College Writing by Kathleen T. McWhorter
2. Writing Academic English by Alice Oshima & Ann Hogue
3. The Write Start: Sentences to Paragraphs by Gayle Feng-Checkett and Lawrence Checkett, 4th Edition.
4. Longman Academic Reading Series 4 by Robert F. Cohen and Judy L. Miller
5. Great Writing 4: Great Essays by Keith S. Folse, April Muchmore-Vokoun, Elena Vestri</td></tr>
<tr><td>Course Goals</td><td>A. Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)
Upon successful completion of this course, students should be able to:
1. Identify the main idea (s) in the text, distinguish facts from opinions, guess meanings of unfamiliar words from context, and make inferences based on comprehension of a text.
2. Utilize a mature writing process that involves prewriting, planning, drafting, revising, and editing/proofreading.
3. Write unified, coherent paragraphs/essays, including effective introductions and conclusions, and transitions between and within paragraphs.
4. Avoid making common grammatical/mechanical mistakes.
5. Design the content and plan their formal presentations effectively.

B. Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs)<table><tr><td>PLO 1</td><td>Computing Knowledge</td><td>Apply knowledge of mathematics, natural sciences, computing fundamentals, and a computing specialization to the solution of complex computing problems.</td></tr></table></td></tr>
</table>

PLO 2	Problem Analysis	Identify, formulate, research literature, and analyze complex computing problems, reaching substantiated conclusions using first principles of mathematics, natural sciences, and computing sciences.
PLO 3	Design/ Develop Solutions	Design solutions for complex computing problems and design systems, components, and processes that meet specified needs with appropriate consideration for public health and safety, cultural, societal, and environmental considerations.
PLO 4	Investigation & Experimentation	Conduct investigation of complex computing problems using research based knowledge and research based methods
PLO 5	Modern Tool Usage	Create, select, and apply appropriate techniques, resources and modern computing tools, including prediction and modelling for complex computing problems.
PLO 6	Society Responsibility	Apply reasoning informed by contextual knowledge to assess societal, health, safety, legal, and cultural issues relevant to context of complex computing problems.
PLO 7	Environment and Sustainability	Understand and evaluate sustainability and impact of professional computing work in the solution of complex computing problems
PLO 8	Ethics	Apply ethical principles and commit to professional ethics and responsibilities and norms of computing practice.
PLO 9	Individual and Team Work	Function effectively as an individual, and as a member or leader in diverse teams and in multi-disciplinary settings.
PLO 10	**Communication**	**Communicate effectively on complex computing activities with the computing community and with society at large.**
PLO 11	Project Management and Finance	Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of management principles and economic decision making and apply these to one's own work as a member or a team.
PLO 12	Life Long Learning	Recognize the need for, and have the preparation and ability to engage in independent and life-long learning in the broadest context of technological changes.

C. Mapping of CLOs to PLOs (CLO: Course Learning Outcome, PLOs: Program Learning Outcomes)		
	PLOs	

		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
CLOs	1												
	2												
	3												
	4												
	5												
	6												

Topics covered in the course (assume 15-week instruction and 3 contact hours per week)

Topics to be covered:

List of Topics	No. of Weeks	Contact Hours	CLO(s)
The Writing Process	1	2	2
Language & Meaning	2	4	4
Paragraph Writing	3	6	3
Essay Writing	2	4	3
Reading Skills	2	6	1
Critical Reading Skills	3	4	1
Using External Sources	1	2	3
Total	16	32	

Programming Language for Assignments				
Class Time Spent (in percentage)	**Theory**	**Problem Analysis**	**Solution Design**	**Social and Ethical Issues**
	45	25	25	5
Oral and Written Communications	Every student is required to submit at least 2 written assignments with a spoken component, 1 project and give 4-5 quizzes.			

Weeks	Contents/Topics	Assessment Items (Case Study/ Exercise Assignment/ Quiz etc.)
Week-01	**Icebreaker Activities** **Course Orientation**	
Week-02	**Language and Meaning (Chapter 3, Human Communication, 6E)** ○ What is language and how it works? ○ Characteristics of Language ○ Using Language effectively. **Written Vs. Spoken Language**	
Week-03	**Critical Reading Skills (Reinforcement from FE)** **Reading Comprehension Passage on Effective Learning**	**Q1**
Week-04	**The Paragraph** ○ The Topic Sentence ○ Support Sentences	
Week-05	○ Paragraph Unity ○ Paragraph Coherence ■ Logical order of events ■ Transitional expressions ■ Key concept repetition ■ Substituting pronouns for nouns ■ Parallelism	
Week-06	**Description** ○ Types of description ○ Dominant impressions ○ Comparisons ■ **Simile** ■ **Metaphor** ■ **Personification**	**A1**
Week-07	**Using outside sources** ○ Using and citing sources ▪ Plagiarism ▪ Correct Citations	**Q2**

<table>
<tr><td></td><td>
Quotations
Reporting verbs and phrases
Punctuating direct quotations
Using direct quotations as support
Changing direct quotations to indirect quotations
Paraphrasing
Summarising</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Week-08</td><td>Assignment-2 (Oral Presentation)</td><td>A2</td></tr>
<tr><td>Week-09</td><td>Comparison & Contrast
Deciding to Compare and/or Contrast.
Point-by-Point Method or Block Method
Transitional Expressions: Connecting comparison and contrast</td><td>Q3</td></tr>
<tr><td>Week-10</td><td>Essay Writing

Types of Paragraphs in a basic Essay:
Introductory Paragraphs
How to Begin an Essay, Developing Thesis Statement, Engaging Strategies
Body Paragraphs
Developing topic sentence & Supporting Details
Transitional Paragraphs
Concluding Paragraphs</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Week-11</td><td>Types of Essays
Argumentative Essay
Developing an Argument Essay
Counterargument and Refutation
Avoiding Faulty Logic
Cause & Effect Essay
Developing a Cause- Effect Essay
Connectors for Cause-Effect Essay</td><td>Q4</td></tr>
<tr><td>Week-12</td><td>Sessional II</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Week-13</td><td>Project</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Week-14</td><td>Project</td><td>Q5</td></tr>
<tr><td>Week-15</td><td>Critical Reading Skills
Reading 1: Bridges to Human Language
Reading 2: Speaking to the Relatives
Reading 3: Language and Morality</td><td>Longman Academic reading series 4</td></tr>
</table>

Week-16	Course Recap/Review/Revision	

Additional Policies for the Course

Google Classroom

i. Join the Google Classroom for your section.
ii. Updates are posted on GCR. It is your responsibility to keep track of respective submissions and any course updates.
iii. Please remember to 'Turn In' your work. It is your responsibility to confirm whether your work is submitted or not.

Attendance Policy

i. 80% attendance is mandatory for one to be eligible to sit for the Final Exam.
ii. Students arriving after 10 minutes, after the class starts will be marked *absent*.
iii. Students arriving within the first 10 minutes after the initial attendance will be marked *late*.
iv. Students leaving the class in the middle of the lecture will be marked absent.

Submission Guidelines

i. Late submissions will **not** be considered. Keep track of the given deadlines.
ii. Digital along with print submissions are required.
iii. Manage your time effectively as you know how much time is required to complete and upload an assignment.
iv. Assessment deadlines will not be changed.

Email Correspondence

i. Use your official email ID for corresponding with your instructors.
ii. Provide complete information like name, student id and which section you are writing from.
iii. Emails will be replied back to within 12-24 hours during the workdays.
iv. Kindly read your email before you click the send button. Your email is representative of your professional identity.